formed by subduction of ocean plate are known as **archipelago**. Islands of Japan form an archipelago.

Marine organisms, the coral polyps colonize the tropical warm water and form islands known as **coral islands**. Lakshadweep Island in Indian Territory is made of corals. Andaman Nicobar islands are of volcanic origin.

Guyots

Flat topped volcanic hills submerged under the sea water are called **guyots**. It is a part of an underwater chain of volcanic mountains produced by slow plate movement.

Seamounts

Seamounts are conical, volcanic hills submerged under ocean water. It does not reach to the water's surface. It is an isolated rise with an elevation of thousand metres or more from the surrounding sea floor and with a limited summit area. It occupies 4.39 percent of ocean region. Seamounts and guyots are most abundant in the North Pacific Ocean.

Bottom relief of Pacific Ocean

Continental shelf of the Eastern Pacific Ocean is very narrow due to the presence of trenches while those on the western coast are wide. Continental shelf adjoining coasts of Australia and Indonesia varies in width from 160 to 1,600 km. In the Pacific Ocean, the abyssal plains are very vast. Absence of mid oceanic ridges is the main reason for deep sea plains. Prominent submarine ridges of the Pacific Ocean are **Albatross plateau**, **Cocas ridge** and **Aleutian ridge.** Tasmania

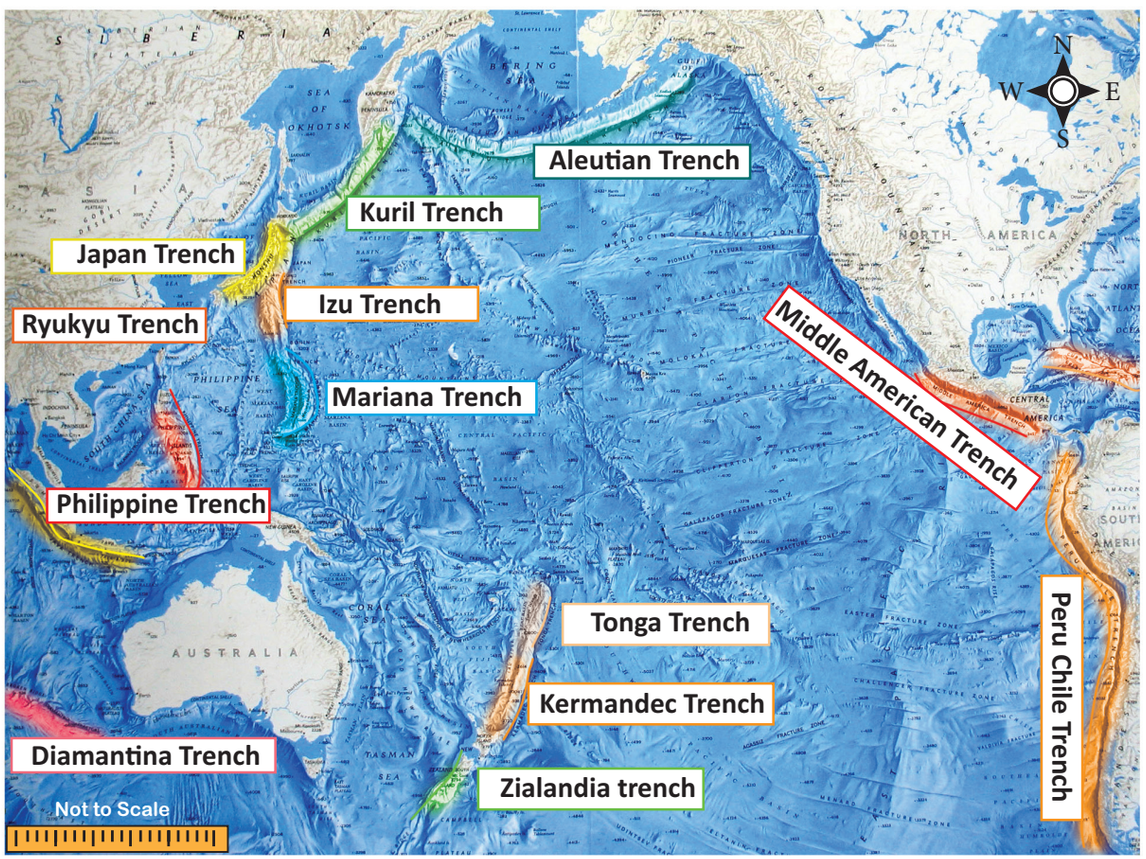


Figure 5.9a Bottom relief of Pacific Ocean

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